

Dre headphones that I also never used. These things netted us \$300. (I split it with her to compensate her for her time.)

Jobs today are scattershot. Many of us have work that is never stable, guaranteed, or predictable. It is hard to explain to my grandmother how or why I make money. (“People pay you to post? On the Internet? Why? What do you do during the day?”)

I’ve been able to put together some savings and a small retirement fund from what I’ve made in the past couple years, but a lot of my recent income went to fixing ten years of irresponsibility—paying back loans and various forms of debt. I’m not out of the woods yet, and because of the way my industry goes, my status can change at any minute. But that lump sum from FX when I was 28 years old allowed me to start filling in the hole and putting a little money away. And sometimes I still end up in an unexpected money bind that requires a quick eBay or freelance writing hustle.

You don’t have to work for an app, although those jobs are the easiest/most common to secure. I worry the market is oversaturated, and there might not be enough work for how many people want to work for apps now. But there are also more apps! One graphic designer friend makes flyers for clients on Fiverr, an app that lets people pay five bucks (or more) for any number of services. If you can provide something someone might wanna throw five bucks at, sign up. (There are also similar apps like the ones I mentioned before, TaskRabbit and Handy.)

If you want to freelance write or draw, make sure you look over every contract you’re given and ask a lot of questions. I constantly worried about seeming annoying, but it’s better to be annoying and protect yourself than to let someone take advantage of you. (If you can have a lawyer or lawyer friend or friend in law school look it over for you, even better.) Make sure there’s a date in writing by which they have to pay you. (No one ever wants to pay you on time.)

Other side hustles can come from your own creativity. A friend named Sam makes limited-run T-shirts based on current events. For instance, if Beyoncé does something amazing, Sam will have a shirt ready for sale in a few hours to capitalize on the trend. They sell out super fast.